**Table 21.3** List of IBSA Summits

| *Summit* | *Date* | *Host Country, City* | *Host Head of State* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1st IBSA | 13 September 2006 | Brazil, Brasília | Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva |
| 2nd IBSA | October 2007 | South Africa, Pretoria | Thabo Mbeki |
| 3rd IBSA | October 2008 | India, New Delhi | Manmohan Singh |
| 4th IBSA | 15 April 2010 | Brazil, Brasília | Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva |
| 5th IBSA | October 2011 | South Africa, Pretoria | Jacob Zuma |
| 6th IBSA | 6 June 2013 | India, New Delhi | Manmohan Singh |
| 7th IBSA | 17 October, 2017 | South Africa, Durban | Maite Nkoana-Mashabane |

The areas of cooperation of IBSA countries are primarily agriculture, climate change, culture, defence, education, energy, health, information society, science and technology, social development, trade and investment, tourism and transport. In the backdrop of the global melt down, the Third IBSA Summit was held at New Delhi in 2008. The major thrust of this Summit was therefore the financial crisis as well as energy and food security, WTO, Climate Change and terrorism. A trilateral trade target of US $25 billion was set to be achieved by 2015. The fourth IBSA Summit held at Brazil adopted two documents along with the Brasilia Declaration. One was the Social Development Strategies and the other was the Future of Agricultural Cooperation in India, Brazil and South Africa. Two MoUs were also signed pertaining to Science, Technology and Innovation and Solar Energy.

IBSA is a fast-emerging trilateral initiative and has a great prospect. IBSA envisions partnership among equals, and if it can successfully prove its credentials, then the members countries would be playing important role in international arena too. These three IBSA countries are the ones which are also forwarding their bid for permanent membership in the UNSC. Therefore, forging a strong tie at this trilateral level would definitely give them an advantage of pushing forward their views at the international level on matters of common concerns of these three countries.

India hosted the Sixth IBSA Summit in New Delhi, on 6 June 2013, which was preceded by a number of meetings of Joint Working Groups and People-to-People Forums. This Summit was very